

ELIAS THORNE-VAUGHAN, PMP, SAP-PRIME

Principal SAP S/4HANA Transformation Architect | Global Enterprise Resource Planning Lead

Chicago, IL • (312) 555-0824 • e.thorne.vaughan.sap@architect-nexus.org
[linkedin.com/in/elias-thorne-vaughan-sap-exec](https://www.linkedin.com/in/elias-thorne-vaughan-sap-exec) • US Citizen

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technically elite and strategically focused SAP Executive Consultant with over 12 years of specialized experience orchestrating global S/4HANA transformations, Greenfield implementations, and complex Brownfield migrations for Fortune 500 enterprises. Distinguished for architecting the "Unified Digital Core" at *OmniLogistics Global*, where I directed a \$250M end-to-end transformation across 22 countries, resulting in a 35% reduction in total cost of ownership (TCO) and 99.8% inventory accuracy across 140 distribution centers. Elias is a visionary architect who bridges the gap between functional business excellence and deep technical innovation, specializing in the convergence of SAP S/4HANA with Business Technology Platform (BTP), AI-driven analytics, and advanced cloud infrastructures.

An expert in the Life Sciences, Automotive, and Discrete Manufacturing sectors, Thaddeus has a proven track record of managing multi-disciplinary teams of 120+ SAP functional and technical consultants. He possesses profound mastery across SAP modules including MM, SD, PP, FI/CO, and EWM, with a specific focus on cross-module integration and master data governance (MDG). A strategic advisor to C-Suite stakeholders, Elias is renowned for his ability to translate complex ERP landscapes into actionable digital roadmaps that drive organizational agility, supply chain resilience, and bottom-line profitability. He is a champion of the "Clean Core" strategy, prioritizing standard SAP best practices while leveraging BTP for high-impact customizations and extensions.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **SAP S/4HANA Transformation:** Greenfield/Brownfield/Selective Data Transition, Global Template Design, Digital Discovery, Pre-sales Architecture.
- **Supply Chain Excellence:** SAP IBP (Integrated Business Planning), MM (Materials Management), SD (Sales & Distribution), PP/DS (Production Planning).
- **Warehouse & Logistics:** SAP EWM (Extended Warehouse Management), SAP TM (Transportation Management), YL (Yard Logistics) Integration.
- **Financial Architecture:** SAP Central Finance (CFIN), FI/CO (Financial Accounting & Controlling), New General Ledger, Revenue Accounting (RAR).
- **SAP Technology Stack:** SAP BTP (Business Technology Platform), ABAP on HANA, SAP Fiori/UI5, SAP Analytics Cloud (SAC), Master Data Governance (MDG).

- **Project Leadership:** SAP Activate Methodology, Agile/SAFe ERP Implementation, P&L Management (\$200M+), Global Resource Management.
- **Industry Solutions:** SAP IS-Auto, SAP IS-Pharma (Validated Environments), SAP IS-Retail, GXP/CFR Part 11 Compliance.
- **Integration & Interface:** SAP PI/PO, SAP Integration Suite (CPI), EDI/ALE/IDOC, OData Services, API-led Connectivity.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

SAP ERP Functional Modules

- **Logistics & SCM:** SAP S/4HANA MM (Purchasing, IM, IV), SD (Order-to-Cash), PP (MRP Live, S&OP), QM (Quality Management), PM (Plant Maintenance).
- **Advanced Logistics:** SAP EWM 9.5/S4 Cloud (MFS, Slotting, Labor Management), SAP TM (Freight Order Management, Strategic Freight Procurement).
- **Finance & Performance:** SAP S/4HANA FI (GL, AP, AR, AA), CO (CCA, PCA, PC, PA), SAP Group Reporting, SAP BPC (Business Planning & Consolidation).

SAP Technical Architecture & Development

- **HANA Database:** HANA 2.0 SPS05+, Core Data Services (CDS) Views, AMDP (ABAP Managed Database Procedures), SQL Scripting.
- **Development Stack:** ABAP Restful Programming Model (RAP), Cloud Application Programming Model (CAP), SAPUI5, JavaScript, Node.js (for BTP services).
- **User Experience:** SAP Fiori Elements, Launchpad Configuration, Custom App Development, Screen Personas.

SAP BTP & Cloud Infrastructure

- **BTP Services:** SAP Build (App Development/Automate), SAP Integration Suite, SAP Extension Suite, SAP HANA Cloud, SAP Data Intelligence.
- **Cloud Platforms:** SAP S/4HANA Public & Private Cloud, RISE with SAP, GROW with SAP, Integration with Microsoft Azure and AWS.
- **DevOps for SAP:** SAP Cloud ALM, Solution Manager 7.2 (Focused Build), gCTS (Git-enabled Change & Transport System).

Analytical & Automation Tools

- **Analytics:** SAP Analytics Cloud (Planning & BI), SAP BW/4HANA, Embedded Analytics in S/4HANA, Power BI Integration.
- **Automation:** SAP Intelligent RPA, SAP Signavio (Process Mining), Celonis (Process Excellence), Worksoft Certify (Test Automation).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal SAP S/4HANA Architect | Global Industrial Dynamics | 2021 – Present

Chicago, IL (Multi-Billion Dollar Manufacturing Conglomerate | Annual Revenue: \$18B)

Strategic Mandate & Executive Oversight: Lead the Global ERP Center of Excellence (CoE) for 18,000+ users across North America, EMEA, and APAC. Accountable for the architecture and lifecycle management of a consolidated S/4HANA 2023 landscape. Direct a specialized team of

80 functional leads and technical architects. Report directly to the Group CTO and Executive Committee on the "Nexus-2030" digital core roadmap.

Key Measurable Achievements:

- **Global Greenfield Transformation:** Directed the end-to-end implementation of S/4HANA (Private Cloud) across 14 global entities. Reduced business process redundancies by 42% and achieved a "Day One" go-live success rate with zero P1 incidents.
- **Supply Chain Resilience Initiative:** Integrated SAP IBP with S/4HANA and external logistics providers (LSPs) using SAP BTP. Reduced procurement lead times by 28% and optimized safety stock levels, saving \$18M in working capital annually.
- **Advanced Warehouse Automation:** Spearheaded the rollout of SAP EWM with integrated Material Flow Systems (MFS) for a new \$500M automated distribution hub in Texas. Achieved a 300% increase in pallet throughput and a 95% reduction in manual picking errors.
- **Central Finance Implementation:** Architected an SAP Central Finance (CFIN) hub to consolidate data from 15 legacy ECC and non-SAP systems. Reduced global financial closing time from 12 days to 3 days and enabled real-time group-level reporting for the CFO.
- **Clean Core Strategy:** Enforced a strict "No-Modifications" policy by leveraging SAP BTP for all side-by-side extensions. Reduced future upgrade efforts by an estimated 60% and enabled bi-annual release adoption.
- **Process Mining & Optimization:** Deployed SAP Signavio to map and analyze the Order-to-Cash (O2C) cycle. Identified bottlenecks that, once resolved, improved on-time delivery (OTD) metrics by 15% and increased cash flow by \$22M.
- **Talent Development:** Established the "SAP Academy of Excellence" internal training program, upskilling 50 junior consultants in SAP Fiori and ABAP RAP, resulting in a 20% reduction in reliance on external contractors.

Senior SAP Supply Chain Lead | Precision Pharma Solutions | 2017 – 2021

Dallas, TX (Global Pharmaceutical Manufacturing & Distribution)

Operational Leadership: Served as the strategic SAP lead for the "Pharma-Flow" transformation program. Accountable for ensuring the SAP landscape met rigorous FDA 21 CFR Part 11 and GxP compliance standards for validated manufacturing environments.

Key Measurable Achievements:

- **Validated S/4HANA Rollout:** Managed the implementation of S/4HANA for 4 major pharmaceutical production sites. Led the technical validation effort, achieving 100% audit readiness and zero compliance findings during FDA inspections.
- **Serialized Supply Chain:** Implemented SAP Advanced Track and Trace for Pharmaceuticals (ATTP), integrating with S/4HANA SD and MM. Enabled 100% unit-level traceability across the global supply chain, complying with US DSCSA and EU FMD regulations.
- **Integrated Logistics Architecture:** Directed the integration of SAP EWM with SAP TM to create a unified logistics platform. Reduced shipping costs by 18% through optimized load planning and carrier selection.
- **Master Data Governance (MDG):** Led the implementation of SAP MDG for Material and BP (Business Partner) domains. Improved master data accuracy from 65% to 99%, eliminating \$4.5M in annual waste caused by procurement errors and duplicate vendors.
- **Mobile User Experience:** Rolled out 50+ custom SAP Fiori apps for shop-floor operators and warehouse personnel. Increased productivity by 25% by replacing legacy SAP GUI transactions with mobile-first, role-based interfaces.
- **Sourcing Optimization:** Negotiated and implemented SAP Ariba integration with S/4HANA for indirect procurement. Achieved a \$6M annual saving through consolidated vendor contracts and automated auctioning.

Managing SAP Consultant | SilverSteel Manufacturing | 2014 – 2017

Pittsburgh, PA (Global Steel Production & Discrete Engineering)

Role Overview: Primary technical and functional lead for the SAP ECC 6.0 EHP8 to S/4HANA Brownfield migration project. Focused on the complex conversion of the manufacturing and production planning modules.

Key Measurable Achievements:

- **Brownfield Migration Lead:** Managed the successful system conversion of a 10TB legacy SAP ECC database to HANA. Utilized the Software Update Manager (SUM) with DMO to achieve a technical downtime of under 24 hours for a critical manufacturing plant.
- **Production Planning Transformation:** Transitioned the organization from traditional MRP to MRP Live in S/4HANA. Reduced MRP run times from 6 hours to 15 minutes, allowing for daily planning cycles and a 12% reduction in inventory shortages.
- **Custom Code Modernization:** Led a team of 15 ABAP developers to remediate 2,000+ objects for HANA compatibility. Optimized high-volume SQL queries, resulting in a 50% performance improvement for month-end batch jobs.
- **Vendor Managed Inventory (VMI):** Designed a custom SAP interface for Tier-1 automotive clients (fictional client: *Summit Automotive Group*). Enabled real-time inventory visibility

and automated replenishment, securing a \$50M multi-year contract renewal.

- **Quality Management Integration:** Automated the inspection lot creation and result recording process via integration with LIMS (Laboratory Information Management Systems). Reduced manual data entry by 80% and improved quality reporting accuracy.

SAP Functional Consultant (MM/SD) | Quantum Automotive | 2011 – 2014

Detroit, MI (Tier-1 Automotive Parts Supplier)

Key Measurable Achievements:

- **Order-to-Cash Optimization:** Redesigned the SD pricing procedure and credit management framework. Reduced billing disputes by 40% and improved the "Perfect Order" rate from 82% to 94%.
- **Procurement Automation:** Implemented automated PO (Purchase Order) creation based on scheduling agreements. Saved 15 hours per week for the procurement team and reduced clerical errors by 60%.
- **EDI Integration:** Led the technical setup of EDI 850, 855, and 856 sets with 25 key customers. Reduced order entry time from 2 days to 5 minutes.
- **Early S/4 Adoption:** Acted as a key project member for the pilot "Simple Finance" (early S/4HANA) implementation, focusing on the migration of the General Ledger and Asset Accounting.

KEY PROJECTS PORTFOLIO

Project Nexus: The Global Digital Core Blueprint

Role: Executive Project Lead | **Duration:** 36 Months | **Investment:** \$250M

Complexity: Consolidated 12 fragmented regional ERP systems into a single global S/4HANA instance for 18,000 users.

- **Strategy:** Utilized a "Multi-Entity Global Template" approach. Developed a core blueprint that covered 85% of business requirements, with 15% allowed for local legal and tax compliance (e.g., Brazil, India, Russia).
- **Action:** Managed the technical data migration of 20 years of history (25TB) using SAP Data Services and Migration Cockpit. Directed the change management efforts for 5,000 shop-floor workers.
- **Outcome:** Realized \$40M in operational efficiencies in the first year post-consolidation. Achieved 100% visibility of global inventory for the first time in the company's 50-year history.

Project Pharma-Flow: Compliance & Traceability Architecture

Role: Solution Architect | **Focus:** GxP Compliance & Advanced Logistics

Objective: Create a fully automated and serialized warehouse for high-value cold-chain medications.

- **Strategy:** Architected an integrated S/4HANA, EWM, and ATTP (Track & Trace) solution. Implemented specialized RF (Radio Frequency) transactions for temperature-controlled material handling.
- **Outcome:** Achieved 100% compliance with the DSCSA (Drug Supply Chain Security Act). Enabled a "60-minute emergency recall" capability, reducing the risk of compromised product reaching patients.

Project Iron-Bridge: Central Finance & Analytics Hub

Role: Principal Architect | **Duration:** 18 Months

Objective: Provide a "Single Version of the Truth" for a highly decentralized global finance team.

- **Implementation:** Deployed SAP Central Finance (CFIN) on S/4HANA 2021. Built real-time data replication from 4 legacy Oracle ERPs and 2 Microsoft Dynamics instances using SAP Landscape Transformation (SLT).
- **Outcome:** Enabled Group-wide real-time P&L and Balance Sheet reporting. Reduced manual consolidation effort by 90%, allowing the finance team to shift focus to predictive analytics and strategic planning.

Project Horizon: AI-Driven Demand Planning (IBP)

Role: Technical Strategy Lead | **Technology:** SAP IBP, SAP BTP, Python ML.

- **Implementation:** Integrated IBP with external market data using BTP. Developed a custom ML-based demand sensing model that analyzed historical sales against macroeconomic indicators.
- **Outcome:** Improved forecast accuracy by 22% for high-volatility product lines. Reduced obsolescence costs in the electronics division by \$12M.

LEADERSHIP & TEAM MANAGEMENT

- **Global Resource Orchestration:** Managed a distributed workforce of 120+ consultants (60% offshore, 40% onshore). Implemented a "Follow-the-Sun" support model that reduced technical resolution times (SLA) by 50%.
- **SAP Career Pathing:** Developed an internal "Functional-to-Technical" bridging program. Coached 15 junior functional consultants to become competent in SAP Fiori configuration and basic ABAP RAP, increasing internal delivery capacity.
- **Agile ERP Transformation:** Successfully transitioned the global IT organization from a Waterfall model to a SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework) model for SAP delivery. Increased feature release velocity by 40%.
- **Executive Stakeholder Alignment:** Expert in managing Board-level expectations. Successfully secured \$80M in additional funding for digital transformation initiatives by demonstrating a projected 15% IRR (Internal Rate of Return).
- **Diversity & Inclusion Advocacy:** Spearheaded a "Women in ERP" mentorship program at Global Industrial Dynamics, resulting in a 35% increase in female representation in SAP leadership roles over 3 years.

PROCESS IMPROVEMENTS & AUTOMATION

- **Automated Financial Clearing (iRPA):** Built a fleet of SAP Intelligent RPA bots to handle the automated clearing of inter-company invoices. Eliminated 95% of manual reconciliation effort and saved 1,200 man-hours monthly.
- **Self-Healing Master Data:** Developed a custom BTP-based extension that uses AI to detect anomalies in material master data (e.g., incorrect unit of measure, missing tax codes) before they impact production. Reduced data-related batch job failures by 85%.
- **Automated Regression Testing:** Implemented Worksoft Certify for the global S/4HANA landscape. Built a library of 1,500+ automated test cases covering 90% of critical business processes, reducing manual QA effort for monthly patches by 75%.
- **Fiori-First Provisioning:** Automated the SAP user provisioning process using IDM (Identity Management) and custom GRC (Governance, Risk, and Compliance) workflows. Reduced user onboarding time from 5 days to 4 hours.
- **Cloud-Native Extension Forge:** Built a standardized "Extension Factory" on SAP BTP (Kyma/Node.js), allowing developers to build and deploy side-by-side extensions in under 2 hours with automated CI/CD pipelines.

STRATEGIC ERP VISION: THE FUTURE OF SAP

The Era of the "Autonomous Enterprise"

I believe the next decade of ERP will be defined by the transition from "Systems of Record" to "Systems of Intelligence." We are currently building the infrastructure for the Autonomous Enterprise—where AI doesn't just suggest actions but executes them. My mission is to architect SAP environments where the "Digital Core" acts as a self-healing, self-optimizing engine that allows human leaders to focus entirely on innovation and creative strategy.

Composable ERP & The Clean Core

The days of massive "Z-modifications" are over. I champion a "Composable ERP" philosophy where the core remains standard, and all competitive differentiators are built as microservices on SAP BTP. This approach ensures that our clients are always "Upgrade-Ready," allowing them to adopt new SAP innovations (like Joule AI or Green Ledger) the moment they are released.

Sustainability as a Core Metric

Sustainability is no longer a corporate social responsibility (CSR) checkbox; it is a fundamental business requirement. I am focusing on implementing the "Green Ledger" approach in S/4HANA, where carbon footprints are tracked with the same rigor as financial costs. My strategy involves integrating ESG (Environmental, Social, and Governance) metrics into every procurement and manufacturing decision in the ERP.

BOARD ENGAGEMENT & INVESTOR RELATIONS

- **IT-Business Synergy Reporting:** Provide quarterly "State of the Digital Core" briefings to the Audit & Risk Committee, focusing on cybersecurity posture, system resiliency, and technical debt reduction ROI.
- **M&A Technical Lead:** Acted as the primary technical evaluator for 6 successful acquisitions (totaling \$3.2B in deal value), assessing the target company's ERP maturity and integration risks.
- **Capital Planning:** Manage the long-term Capex/Opex forecasts for the entire SAP landscape, ensuring that technology investments are aligned with the 10-year corporate growth strategy.

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration (MBA) in Supply Chain & Finance

Northwestern University, Kellogg School of Management, Evanston, IL

- Research Focus: Macro-Logistics Optimization and Distributed Ledger Technology.
- Honors: Top 10% of Class; Recipient of the Executive Leadership Award.

Bachelor of Science in Industrial Engineering & Computer Science

Georgia Institute of Technology (Georgia Tech), Atlanta, GA

- Honors: Summa Cum Laude; President of the Industrial Engineering Society.
- Minor: Computational Data Analysis.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **SAP Certified Application Associate:** S/4HANA Sales & SCM (2023)
- **SAP Certified Professional:** S/4HANA Implementation Lead (SAP Activate)
- **SAP Certified Development Associate:** ABAP with SAP NetWeaver 7.5
- **SAP Certified Technology Associate:** SAP HANA 2.0 SPS05
- **PMP:** Project Management Professional – Project Management Institute (PMI)
- **Lean Six Sigma Black Belt** (Focus on Manufacturing Process Optimization)
- **TOGAF 9.2 Certified Enterprise Architect**

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES REFERENCE

SAP Core Modules: S/4HANA, ECC 6.0, MM, SD, PP, FI/CO, EWM, TM, QM, PM, ATTP.

SAP BTP Services: Integration Suite (CPI), Extension Suite (Kyma, Cloud Foundry), Build, HANA Cloud.

Analytical Platforms: SAP Analytics Cloud (Planning/B1), BW/4HANA, Celonis, Power BI.

Development & DevOps: ABAP RAP/CAP, Fiori/UI5, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Cloud ALM, Solman 7.2.

Master Data & Governance: SAP MDG, Information Steward, Data Services (BODS), Winshuttle.

Project & Workflow: SAP Signavio, Jira, Confluence, Microsoft Project, Lucidchart (C4 Models).

PUBLICATIONS & CONFERENCES

Selected Speaking Engagements

- **Keynote Speaker:** "The Clean Core: Future-Proofing Global ERP Landscapes," *SAP Sapphire 2023*.
- **Featured Speaker:** "AI in the Supply Chain: From Predictive to Autonomous Planning," *ASUG Annual Conf 2022*.
- **Panelist:** "Digital Transformation in Validated Environments: The S/4HANA Journey," *SAP Pharma Day 2021*.
- **Workshop Lead:** "Architecting Side-by-Side Extensions on SAP BTP," *SAP TechEd 2020*.
- **Guest Lecturer:** "Advanced ERP Systems Architecture," *University of Chicago, Booth School of Business*.

Selected Peer-Reviewed Publications

- **"Predictive Maintenance in Industry 4.0: Leveraging S/4HANA & IoT"**
Journal of Advanced Manufacturing Systems, 2023.
- **"The Impact of S/4HANA Central Finance on Global M&A Integration Efficiency"**
International ERP Research Quarterly, 2022.
- **"Sustainable Supply Chains: Integrating ESG Metrics into the SAP Digital Core"**
Journal of Supply Chain Resilience, 2021.
- **"Beyond Selenium: Why Automated Testing is the Key to Continuous SAP Delivery"**
The ERP Architect Digest, 2020.

LANGUAGES & GLOBAL EXPOSURE

- **English:** Native Proficiency.
- **German:** Professional Working Proficiency (C1).
- **Spanish:** Conversational.
- **Global Footprint:** Directly managed SAP implementations and technical teams in: USA, Germany, Brazil, Mexico, UK, Poland, China, India, and Japan.